

Delim

This project may appeal to programmers who dislike the indentation-based structure in CoffeeScript but otherwise like the language for its simplicity, terseness and expressiveness.

Although CoffeeScript was influenced by Python and Ruby, it uses neither Python's colon nor Ruby's **end** keyword. **Delim** reintroduces both to clearly delimit code blocks.

- 1) A code block is opened with a trailing colon and is terminated with a **end** keyword.
- 2) Exceptionally, a **switch** construct must be terminated with **end switch**.
- 3) A function block is still opened with a trailing arrow. A colon is allowed but it is redundant.
- 4) A one-liner still uses the CoffeeScript's **then** keyword, not a colon.

This offers some advantages:

- Whitespace is no longer significant.
- Some people feel more comfortable with the structural integrity of delimited blocks.
- Safe copy-pasting without worrying about indentation levels.
- Safe auto-formatting.

Syntax restrictions

Delim is a simple text preprocessor without a stack or a lexer. It works mostly on a line-by-line basis. As a result, it has a few syntax restrictions, which are listed below. Fortunately, they align with recommended coding practices and help improve readability.

- No comment is allowed after a trailing colon or a trailing arrow.
- Only use code blocks throughout a multi-line **if**, **switch**, or **try** constructs.

Usage

Delim outputs to *stdout*.

--format option reindents lines consistently, the code remains unchanged.

delim [*--format*] <script>.coffee

Typical usage

The CoffeeScript compiler must be installed to get JavaScript.

```
# Convert and compile to JavaScript in one step
delim script.coffee | coffee -s -c > script.js
```

```
# Get a converted copy of a source
delim script.coffee > script.converted.coffee
```

```
# Get a formatted copy of a source
delim --format script.coffee > script.formatted.coffee
```

General syntax

The added syntax to CoffeeScript is in **red**.

```
functionName = (parms) ->  
  code  
end
```

```
functionName = (parms) -> code
```

```
do ->  
  code  
end
```

```
do -> code
```

```
[variable =] if <condition>:  
  code  
else if <condition>:  
  code  
else :  
  code  
end
```

```
[variable =] if <condition> then code [else code]
```

```
code if <condition>
```

```
[variable =] while <condition> [guard clauses] :  
  code  
end
```

```
[variable =] while <condition> [guard clauses] then code
```

General syntax (continued)

```
[variable =] for <iterable> [guard clauses] :  
  code  
end
```

```
[variable =] for <iterable> [guard clauses] then code
```

```
[variable =] switch [variable] :  
  when <condition> :  
    code  
  [when <condition> :  
    code]  
  [else :  
    code]  
end switch
```

```
try :  
  code  
[catch [var] :  
  code]  
[finally :  
  code]  
end
```

```
class name :  
  code  
end
```